

Precrastination

What is it?

The urge to complete tasks quickly just to feel relief that it's done.

History

Formally discussed in research around **2014**, showing that people rush to finish tasks even if it takes more physical or mental effort overall.

The Psychology Behind It

Humans want to reduce mental load fast. Finishing something early gives instant relief, even if the outcome is lower quality. This leads people to prioritize “completion feeling” over doing it correctly or efficiently.

Why It Matters

- Rushed decisions
- Mistakes in data entry
- Incomplete flows
- Lower satisfaction
- Higher checkout drop-offs

How to Apply It

- Break tasks into smaller guided steps
- Add lightweight review moments before submission
- Use progress indicators
- Nudge users to pause just enough to avoid errors

Theory in Action

LinkedIn uses step-by-step guided onboarding to prevent rushed profile creation.
IKEA uses visual manuals so people don't skip critical assembly steps.

Final Thought

People rush to finish — even before thinking. Smart design slows users down just enough to protect them from sloppy action, without frustrating their natural desire to feel things are done.